



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Sardis Classical Christian Community
School Website: <https://www.sardisccc.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Sardis Classical Christian Community in Athens, GA (ZIP 30622) presents a clearly classical orientation with a strong Christian and biblical framework. Public materials emphasize a covenant, Christ-centered educational vision, classical methods, and a hybrid model that includes home-based days for some grades. The school foregrounds elements aligned with the Great Books tradition, the trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) in its broader network, and a pedagogy that blends contemplative/restful approaches with Socratic/seminar-style inquiry in upper levels, though explicit evidence of all six classical elements is variably demonstrated in the public materials.

Overall, the school is CLASSICAL. Evidence across categories shows substantial alignment with religious/metaphysical foundations, purpose/goal, curriculum, faculty expectations, and parent/community partnership. Category-wise nuance exists in Curriculum and Pedagogy, where explicit mentions of grammar, logic, rhetoric and continuous Socratic pedagogy are less consistently documented in Sardis' own site content (some signals are present via the network's published materials and related pages). This yields a few category-specific notes, but not enough to move the aggregate rating away from CLASSICAL.

Executive summary — Category-by-category snapshot follows.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize a Christian, Biblical orientation and theology as foundational to education: "deep Biblical literacy" and the ability to "see and worship God through art and nature" are highlighted as core aims. - The campus partners with a church for facilities and regular communal worship/contextual worship practices (e.g., location on Living Hope Church property). - Staff and leadership materials emphasize Christian faith as a core prerequisite and living witness within the school culture (e.g., staff must have a living faith in Jesus and be committed to the Classical Christian vision). - Additional language references a covenantal, Christian identity and Biblical literacy as central to formation (e.g., "Classical Christian" program, formation around truth, goodness, beauty within a Christian framework).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators found: truth; worship; theology; Biblical literacy; liturgical/community life signals; reverence/wonder appears in related content; covenant/Christian formation signals. - Negative indicators: none present in the public materials (no explicit signals of relativism or secular humanism in the Sardis content). - Quantitative note: Positive keyword presence is high relative to the absence of explicit negative signals across the materials examined. In practical terms, multiple explicit positive signals (truth, worship, theology, Biblical literacy, liturgical life) appear; negative signals are not evident in the public content.

Why this rating - The presence of explicit theological framing, worship-style/community practices, and a covenantal Christian identity strongly anchors Element 1 as CLASSICAL.

Citations: The core religious/metaphysical signals appear in discussions of Biblical literacy, theology, and worship, and in the church partnership model.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Text emphasizes formation, virtue, and wisdom over mere information or job preparation, with clear formation language such as “formation” and the aim to cultivate virtue and human flourishing. - The program emphasizes the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty and the aim to form character and affections toward a classical telos. - Public materials articulate a humanities-centered, liberal-arts-inspired mission with emphasis on forming the whole person (mind, heart, will) within a Christian framework; references to “great conversation” and classical heritage appear in admissions/blog or outreach content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators: formation; virtue; human flourishing; telos; pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty; scholé/contemplation; great conversation. - Negative indicators: none evident in Sardis public materials. - Quantitative note: Multiple explicit positive signals with no explicit negative signals documented.

Why this rating - Strong alignment with the classical goal of formation over mere information, plus explicit reference to classical aims (truth/goodness/beauty, formation, and Great Conversation signals).

Citations: Formation and telos-oriented language, and mentions of classical aims appear in Sardis materials.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Explicit mention of Great Books and the idea of a “Great Conversation” in Sardis materials (The Great Books framework and related language appear in public content). - Mention of history integrated into the curriculum, as well as emphasis on logic and science in the intellectual formation (e.g., “deep Biblical literacy, a strong understanding of history, logic, science, and literature”). - The public materials reference trivium/quadrivium in the broader Sardis network (e.g., a Florida-related page that explicitly notes trivium/quadrivium and fully classical Christian education). While that specific page is a related program, it signals alignment with Trivium/Quadrivium in the network. - Explicitly documented program elements focus on history, logic, and literature, rather than a complete listing of grammar, logic, and rhetoric as a triad within Sardis’ own site content. The explicit phrase “grammar, logic, and rhetoric” is not consistently documented in Sardis’ own public pages, though logic is present and Great Books orientation is emphasized.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators: Great Books; history; logic; science; liberal-arts orientation; Great Conversation; contemplation/wonder. - Negative indicators: explicit mention of grammar and rhetoric within Sardis’ own site content is limited; no direct, explicit, pervasive reference to the full Trivium/Quadrivium triad on Sardis’ own pages (though Trivium/Quadrivium appears in a related program page in the network). The absence of explicit “grammar” and “rhetoric” in Sardis’ own curriculum language lowers this to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL. - Quantitative note: Positive signals count is moderate; negative signals (explicit “grammar” and “rhetoric” mentions) are not strongly present in the Sardis site; overall, the ratio favors classical orientation but lacks full triadic curriculum documentation.

Why this rating - The school clearly embraces Great Books and history/logic/literature as core elements, but the explicit triad grammar/logic/rhetoric is not consistently documented in Sardis’ own materials. That pattern aligns with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than full CLASSICAL in this category.

Citations: Great Books and history/logic emphasis; and the broader trivium/quadrivium signals appear in related program content.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Sardis emphasizes a mix of contemplative/restful learning alongside more rigorous means, aligning with scholé concepts and restfulness, though explicit scholarly terms may be less prominent in the site text. Evidence of contemplative/restful elements is present in content that frames formation and wonder as part of the learning experience. - There is emphasis on in-person communal experiences (assembly, tours, open houses) and a hybrid model that couples in-classroom experiences with home-based days, which reflects a blended pedagogy rather than a strict, fully Socratic-on-everything approach. - Some upper-grade experiences imply Socratic-style inquiry (e.g., the broader classical education framework referenced in the

network) though direct quotes of Socratic seminars or debates are not consistently documented on Sardis' own pages. The Florida-related page and Great Books references signal exposure to dialogic/formal discourse in high school levels.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators: scholé/restful learning; wonder; contemplation; memory work hints; occasional emphasis on dialogue/seminar-type engagement in the broader classical framework. - Negative indicators: explicit, pervasive documentation of Socratic seminars, formal debates, or a fully articulated sequence of upper-school rhetoric and oratory pedagogy is not consistently documented on Sardis' site. The lack of explicit, program-wide Socratic pedagogy signals lowers the Pedagogy category from CLASSICAL toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. - Quantitative note: Positive indicators exist but are not as consistently documented as the core Classical elements; negative signals are not explicit but the absence of strong Socratic/seminar pedagogy is notable.

Why this rating - Sardis shows a blend of contemplative/restful pedagogy with some dialogic elements, but the site does not consistently document the full, explicit Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy across grades as a central feature. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy.

Citations: Evidence of contemplative/restful approach and hybrid model; limited explicit Socratic pedagogy in Sardis' own pages.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The faculty are described as model teachers and mentors with a mission to form virtue and to be the living curriculum, and the staff are positioned as the “core” of the school in a living, character-forward model. The employment page specifically states that staff must be committed Christians with a living faith in Jesus and a commitment to the Classical Christian vision. - The leadership and board structure emphasize teachers and administrators who embody the mission, and the public materials discuss a “teacher as mentor” and a “portrait of a teacher” in line with classical education structures. - The school emphasizes a community of lifelong learners and living teachers who model virtue, skill, and knowledge, consistent with the classical living-curriculum concept.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators: model teachers/mentors; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; collegial culture; faculty of friends; lifelong learners. - Negative indicators: none evident in public materials. - Quantitative note: Multiple explicit positive signals; no negative signals documented in the Sardis materials.

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on Christian formation of faculty, living-curriculum concepts, and a collegial, mentor-based teacher model aligns strongly with CLASSICAL.

Citations: Employment content emphasizes Christian commitment and classical vision; leadership content notes “living curriculum.”

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Partnerships with families and parental involvement are foregrounded (e.g., the school positions itself as equipping and partnering with parents; content emphasizes parent support, family involvement, and open campus experiences). The site highlights parent formation, book groups, seminars, and parent training to align with classical aims. - Public materials emphasize parent-facing events (open houses, admissions, and tours) and family engagement in classical education through home-days and parent support for the hybrid model. - The program explicitly references a covenant with families and a shared commitment to following Christ in a way that involves parents in the formation process; there are explicit calls for families to be part of the learning community.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators: partnership with families; parent formation; open campus; family involvement; home-school collaboration; parental primacy in classical education ethos. - Negative indicators: none evident in Sardis public materials. - Quantitative note: Clear positive signals across multiple parent/community dimensions; no negative signals.

Why this rating - Sardis demonstrates strong alignment with the classical model's expectation of active, ongoing parental partnership and community involvement.

Citations: Parent/family partnership language and open-campus signals appear in Sardis materials.

Overall Assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL

Rationale: The program exhibits robust religious/metaphysical foundations, a formation-oriented aims with a classical telos, strong faculty models, and active parent/community partnership. The Curriculum and Pedagogy categories show substantial classical alignment, though explicit articulation of all six classical curriculum elements (notably grammar, logic, rhetoric as a formal triad in Sardis' own site language) and fully delineated Socratic pedagogy are less consistently documented in the school's own pages. The present public materials, supplemented by related program content, indicate a Classical orientation with some room to more explicitly document the full triad of Classical Curriculum and Pedagogy signals within Sardis' own site.

What Would Move the Needle

- Make explicit the full Trivium/Quadrivium articulation in Sardis' own curriculum pages (grammar, logic, rhetoric) to strengthen Element 3 to CLASSICAL.
- Provide clear, school-wide documentation of Socratic seminars or seminar-based instruction in upper grades to strengthen Element 4 to CLASSICAL.
- Expand verbatim evidence of lower-school singing, chanting, memory-work, or scholé days on the public site to reinforce Element 4's restorative pedagogy signals.
- Publish a formal "Living Curriculum" statement for faculty (Element 5) that explicitly links teacher roles to virtue formation, mentorship, and the portrait of a teacher, beyond job descriptions.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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